Rotary Club of Freetown-Sunset

CREATE LASTING IMPACT



EDITION 01 · JULY 1 – NOVEMBER 15, 2026

Sunset Impact

The newsletter of the Rotary Club of Freetown-Sunset

COVER STORY

Bringing Clean Water Closer To Communities

All six Global Grant boreholes handed over in Bombali District.

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JULY 4 AND NOV 7 2026 · BOMBALI DISTRICT

Bringing Clean Water Closer to Communities: All Six Boreholes Handed Over in Bombali







Rotarians at the handover of the Kakorla and Kerefay Loko MCHP community wells, July 4, 2026.

One of our major service milestones this Rotary year has been the successful completion of the Safe Water for Rural Health Facilities in Bombali District Global Grant Project, through which we have helped improve access to safe and reliable water at six rural health facilities.

Our journey began on July 4, when we marked the handover of the first two boreholes at Kakorla Maternal Child Health Post and Kerefay Loko Maternal Child Health Post. The handover was an important step in bringing safe water closer to mothers, newborns, children and healthcare workers who previously depended on unsafe water sources.

On Saturday, November 7, we returned to Bombali District with our partners, World Hope International and Rotary Club of Naperville Sunrise, USA, for the official handover of the remaining four boreholes. This brought the project to a significant milestone, with all six boreholes successfully constructed and handed over to their beneficiary communities.

During the November handover, community stakeholders, traditional leaders and healthcare workers expressed their appreciation and shared experiences of the challenges they previously faced accessing safe drinking water, both for their households and for patients receiving care at the health facilities.

With all six boreholes completed and handed over, the project's implementation phase has officially concluded. Our partners will now focus on finalising the project report and financial documentation.

We are grateful to World Hope International, Rotary Club of Naperville Sunrise, community leaders, healthcare workers and everyone whose commitment and collaboration helped make this project possible.

Through this partnership, we have taken an important step towards safer water, healthier communities and lasting impact.

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WITH THANKS

We extend our appreciation to Rotarians Assistant Governor Millicent Cole, President Abdul Manaff Kemokai, Immediate Past President Musa Bernard Komeh, Alison French, Christopher Greene and Lyndon Baines-Johnson for their time and support.

AUGUST – NOVEMBER 2026

Rotarian Spotlight: celebrating our members

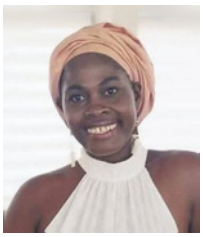
Ourmembers areat the heart ofeverything wedo. Through our RotarianSpotlightseries,we have been sharing the experiences, professional expertise and personal journeys of our members, while highlighting the different ways we contribute to Rotary and our communities. Between August and November, we featured eight Rotarians:

AUGUST

MEMBERSHIP MONTH

Rtn. Saio, Rtn. Ajara, Rtn. Immediate Past President Komeh and Rtn. Esther shared their perspectives on membership and their Rotary journeys.


Rtn. Saio


Rtn. Ajara


Rtn. Komeh


Rtn. Esther

SEPTEMBER

BASIC EDUCATION AND LITERACY MONTH

Rtn. President Manaff and Rtn. Ariana shared their experiences and perspectives on the importance of education and literacy.


Rtn. President Manaff


Rtn. Ariana

OCTOBER

WORLD POLIO DAY

Rtn. Haja, a public health professional, shared insights on polio eradication, current public health developments and Rotary's role in the global fight against polio.


Rtn. Haja

NOVEMBER

ROTARY FOUNDATION MONTH

Rtn. Lyndon, our Club Foundation Chair, shared insights on The Rotary Foundation, its global impact and the importance of member contributions.


Rtn. Lyndon

Through these features, we are celebrating the people behind our service and creating opportunities to learn from one another. We look forward to sharing more of our members' stories in the months ahead.

AUGUST 22, 2026 · ROTARY CLUB OF BO

Assistant Governor's visit to Bo



Members of the Rotary Club of Bo during the Assistant Governor's visit on August 22, 2026.

Our Assistant Governor, Millicent Cole, visited the Rotary Club of Bo on August 22, 2026. The visit provided an opportunity to engage with fellow Rotarians, learn about their work and discuss priorities for the Rotary year. Chartered in 1988, the Rotary Club of Bo is the second-oldest Rotary club currently in Sierra Leone. Despite having a relatively small number of active members, the club continues to deliver meaningful projects.

During the visit, we learned about completed initiatives, including public toilet facilities for a market in Mofombo and a solar-powered school water system, as well as hygiene education at Buddy Aladura.

We also heard about ongoing initiatives, including the White Stone Sweet Bread bakery project, malaria awareness, midwife training, and epilepsy awareness and treatment support.

Assistant Governor Millicent Cole delivered a 45-minute presentation focused on membership growth, community impact and increasing Rotary's visibility in Bo and the wider district.

Members were encouraged to strengthen their contributions to The Rotary Foundation and Polio Fund, improve their club's public image and continue sharing Rotary's story.

The visit was a valuable opportunity to exchange ideas, reflect on our shared responsibilities as Rotarians and encourage continued growth and impact across the district.

INVESTING IN EDUCATION · BASIC EDUCATION AND LITERACY MONTH

Our back-to-school drive at Russell

September 25, 2026 · Rural Education Committee Primary School, Russell Boyoh Village













Pupils, parents, teachers and Rotarians at the back-to-school drive. Bottom row: awards presented to top-performing pupils.

As part of Rotary's Basic Education and Literacy Month, we held our annual scholarship and back-to-school drive at Rural Education Committee Primary School.

Through this initiative, we provided school supplies, uniforms and monetary awards to some of the school's highest-performing pupils.

Two outstanding pupils from each class were recognised, alongside the school's top-performing NPSE pupils.

It was wonderful to have parents join teachers, Rotarians and pupils in celebrating the children's achievements. Their participation reminded us of the importance of family and community involvement in education. Through our continued partnership with the school, we remain committed to encouraging academic excellence, supporting learners and investing in the next generation.





STRENGTHENING MEMBERSHIP

District Membership Seminar

September26,2026 · CouncilofChurchesHall,KingharmanRoad, Freetown

We participated intheDistrictMembershipSeminar, joiningfellow Rotarians and Rotaractors for practical discussions on membership recruitment, retention, and club development.

The seminar explored strategies for attracting prospective members, managing membership pipelines, identifying signs of member disengagement and creating stronger club experiences.

A total of 58 participants attended, comprising 44 Rotarians and 14 Rotaractors. The discussions reinforced an important message: sustainable membership growth goes beyond recruitment. It requires intentional engagement, meaningful experiences, and a commitment to retaining and developing members.

We left with useful ideas and recommendations to strengthen our membership efforts and build more vibrant Rotary clubs.

58
PARTICIPANTS
44 Rotarians
14 Rotaractors

OCTOBER 24, 2026 · WORLD POLIO DAY

Painting towards a polio-free world





Rotarians, Rotaractors and Interactors at the joint Paint for Polio activity on World Polio Day.

On World Polio Day, we joined our Interact and Rotaract family for a joint Paint for Polio activity.

Through this creative activity, we came together around one shared purpose: raising awareness and strengthening the global fight to eradicate polio.

We also continued our commitment to the End Polio Now campaign. A total of 25 of our 57 members contributed to the Polio Fund, representing approximately 44% of our membership.

The fight against polio does not end on October 24. Until every child is protected and transmission is stopped, our work must continue. Through advocacy, awareness, vaccination and financial support, we remain part of the global effort to create a polio-free world.

25 of 57
MEMBERS GAVE TO THE POLIO FUND
About 44% of our membership

NOVEMBER 2026 · ROTARY FOUNDATION MONTH

Giving to create lasting impact





CLUB FOUNDATION CHAIR
Rtn. Lyndon Baines-Johnson

Club President Rtn. Manaff presents Rtn. Agatha Seriki Vandy with her Paul Harris Fellow recognition at our November 4, 2026 meeting.

November gave us an opportunity to reflect on the impact of The Rotary Foundation and the role each of us plays in supporting its work.

At our November 4, 2026 meeting, we welcomed Rtn. Lyndon Baines-Johnson, our Club Foundation Chair, who spoke about The Rotary Foundation, its global impact and the importance of member contributions.

His presentation highlighted how the Foundation transforms generosity into meaningful service, supporting projects in areas such as disease prevention, education, clean water, maternal and child health, peacebuilding and community development. He also encouraged us to deepen our understanding of the Foundation and recognise that every contribution, no matter the size, helps make lasting impact possible.

The meeting was made even more special with the recognition of our Club Administration Chair, Rtn. Agatha Seriki Vandy, as a Paul Harris Fellow.

A Paul Harris Fellow recognition celebrates an individual's support for The Rotary Foundation and its mission of advancing world understanding, goodwill and peace through service. It is a meaningful reminder of the difference that generosity and commitment to Rotary's ideals can make.

We congratulate Rtn. Agatha Seriki Vandy on this recognition and celebrate the spirit of giving that continues to strengthen our Rotary family.

As we marked Foundation Month, we were reminded that through The Rotary Foundation, our generosity reaches beyond our club and helps create lasting change in communities around the world.

CONGRATULATIONS

Rtn. Agatha Seriki Vandy, Paul Harris Fellow
Club Administration Chair, Rotary Club of Freetown-Sunset

> *Every contribution, no matter the size, helps make lasting impact possible.*

JULY 1 – NOVEMBER 15, 2026

Guest speakers: learning through shared experiences

FromJuly 1 toNovember 15,wewelcomedsix guestspeakers toourmeetings. Their presentationsbrought valuable knowledge, professional experience and fresh perspectives to our discussions, while connecting with Rotary's monthly themes.

JULY

MATERNAL AND CHILD HEALTH



Maurice Ferenkeh Koroma



Cyrus Sheriff

We welcomed Maurice Ferenkeh Koroma and Cyrus Sheriff, who spoke on child and maternal health.

Their presentations highlighted the importance of accessible healthcare, maternal wellbeing and the protection of children, reminding us that healthier communities begin with mothers and children receiving the care and support they need.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Investing in maternal and child health is an investment in the wellbeing and future of our communities.

AUGUST

MEMBERSHIP



PAG Sheila John



PAG Christian Kamara

During Membership Month, we welcomed Past Assistant Governor (PAG) Sheila John and PAG Christian Kamara, who shared their insights on Rotary membership.

Their discussions explored the importance of attracting new members, creating meaningful club experiences and retaining members through engagement, fellowship and service.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Membershipgrowth is not simply about bringing people into Rotary. It is about creating an environment where members feel valued, connected and inspired to serve.

SEPTEMBER

BASIC EDUCATION AND LITERACY



Boi-Jenneh Jalloh



Dr. Miriam Theresa Mason-Sesay

We welcomed Boi-Jenneh Jalloh and Dr. Miriam Theresa Mason-Sesay, who spoke on basic education and literacy.

Their presentations highlighted the importance of access to quality education, literacy development and the role of individuals and communities in creating opportunities for learners.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Education opens doors, strengthens communities and gives individuals the tools to shape their futures.

CELEBRATING ROTARIANS WHO SHARE THEIR KNOWLEDGE

Of our six guest speakers, three were fellow Rotarians: Maurice Ferenkeh Koroma, PAG Sheila John and PAG Christian Kamara. We appreciate their willingness to share their professional knowledge and Rotary experiences with us. Their contributions also remind us that the strength of Rotary lies in the knowledge, expertise and commitment our members bring to service.

We are grateful to all six speakers for giving their time, sharing their insights and enriching our club meetings.

PUBLIC IMAGE

Strengthening our public image

Over the past few months, wehavetaken importantstepsto strengthen how we communicate our work, engage with the media and tell our Rotary story. Some of our key developments include:

- We established a media database covering traditional and digital media contacts across Sierra Leone.
- We arranged photography coverage for our September 25 school distribution at Russell.
- We secured coverage on Capital Radio's news bulletin on September 26, with our activities featured during the 8:00 AM, 9:00 AM and 10:00 AM news slots.
- We developed and signed a service agreement with a Digital Design and Web Support Consultant to support our communications and website development.
- We established a Canva Business account for our design and content production.
- We created a dedicated Public Image email: rcfspublicimage@gmail.com.
- We established a Google Drive repository to organise and preserve our Public Image content and materials.

These developments are helping us build a more consistent and coordinated approach to communicating our work and increasing our visibility.

IN THE NEWS

Featuredon Capital Radio

Our activities were covered in the 8:00 AM, 9:00 AM and 10:00 AM news bulletins on September 26, 2026.

CONTACT PUBLIC IMAGE

rcfspublicimage@gmail.com

@rcfsunset

Rotary Club of Freetown-Sunset

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

Coming up

12 DEC — **Club Assembly and Elections**
Saturday, December 12 2026

30 JAN — **BBQ Fundraiser**
Saturday, January 30 2027

TBC — **District Governor's visit**
Date to be confirmed

VISIT US ONLINE

www.rcfsunset.org

LOOKING AHEAD

As we continue through the Rotary year, we remain focused on strengthening our membership, deepening our community partnerships, supporting The Rotary Foundation and increasing the visibility of our service.

Every project, meeting, partnership and contribution is an opportunity to create meaningful change. We look forward to sharing more of our journey as we continue to put service into action.

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Create Lasting Impact